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NEWSPAPER

19th July, 2018

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29th WEEK



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GS II ... International Relations



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NEWSPAPER EDITORIALS

... DISCUSSION

19th JULY, 2018

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Rocky summit

Donald Trump did enough, and more, to mess up his meeting with Vladimir Putin

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Decoding Trump's attack on Europe

His incendiary tour of the continent seeks to reverse the gains Europe has achieved over the last 70 years



RAVI ARVIND DATT

U.S. President Donald Trump's incendiary tour of Europe has justly generated extensive coverage for his disregard for diplomatic niceties and attacks on his allies, especially on German Chancellor Angela Merkel and British Prime Minister Theresa May, both of whom are facing stiff domestic opposition. Yet, mainstream commentaries on Mr. Trump's attacks on the European Union and the North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO) do not place the trans-Atlantic relationship in the broader historical context.

In the first instance, in the aftermath of the Second World War, the U.S. promoted economic integration among its European allies as an essential condition for the post-war revival of world trade. At war's end, wealth had become concentrated in the new superpower – it accounted for 48% of world industrial capacity and 70% of gold reserves. With the demobilisation of some 12 million soldiers in the U.S., the shift to a peacetime economy needed allies to open their markets to U.S. products and investments. Its European allies were too poor to provide a market and the notorious 'iron curtain' 50th Congress unwilling to undertake a programme for European reconstruction.

Post-war reconstruction
A trans-Atlantic military alliance and European economic integration were thus the twin prongs of a successful post-war reconstruction. Economic integration proceeded rapidly over the last 40 years, with the European Union (EU) becoming the largest economy on the planet and thereby

threatening the U.S. At the same time, the rationale for the NATO military alliance – to protect Western Europe from Soviet expansion and to tie Germany to its neighbours – has largely evaporated with the breakup of the USSR and the dissolution of the Warsaw Pact.

The Russian angle
In the context of the current outcry among NATO member states about the Russian annexation of Crimea from the Ukraine, it is important to recall that U.S. President George H.W. Bush and other leaders had assumed Russia in 1999 that the trans-Atlantic alliance would not extend beyond East Germany's borders. Then when Russia was intensely weakened in the 1990s, U.S. President Bill Clinton led the charge to invite states in Central and Eastern Europe into the alliance. It was this expansion that led to a new confrontation with Russia once it had stabilised itself under President Vladimir Putin.

Nevertheless, there is clearly no Russian threat to Europe. Even in

the case of the Ukraine, as Steven Cohen, senior professor of Russian studies at New York University, has argued, the crisis was precipitated in 2014 when the EU pressured the Ukrainian government to sign an agreement that would have disadvantaged Russia. When then Ukrainian President Viktor Yanukovich hesitated, he was overthrown by EU- and U.S.-supported demonstrators even though he had signed an agreement headed by three EU foreign ministers the previous day to form a coalition government. It was this march of NATO to the borders of Russia that provoked Mr. Putin to intervene in the Ukraine.

Rescuing security
Far from Russia posing a threat to the Western alliance, the major source of destabilisation to the EU comes from the flow of migrants from Africa. In this context, it is not higher military spending by member states that is crucial but the provision of aid. Members of the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development had pledged to contribute 0.7% of their GDP to aid to the poorest countries. Germany and the U.S. spend 0.66% and 0.7%, respectively, of their GDP in aid while the U.S. spends a mere 0.08%. Mr. Trump is threatening to slash even that by a third. Spending on aid, especially to African countries, will help even the tide of refugees coming to Europe far more effectively than policing the Mediterranean.

In this context, Mr. Trump's blustering attack on European states for not meeting their military spending obligations is mis-

placed. Not only does he fail to recognise that their military spending has risen since 2004 when they agreed to raise their military spending to 2% of their GDP by 2014 but also that European states are not positioned to be global powers. Unlike the U.S. which is bordered by the Atlantic and Pacific Oceans, Europe has no need for navies to patrol distant oceans and match the U.S. in defence spending. Moreover, rather than spending miserably on defence as the U.S. has opted to do, European states provide their citizens with health care, education, and other welfare benefits.

Mr. Trump's support for Brexit and his humiliating undermining of Ms. May, his outrageous comments on Germany being beholden to Russia and on Ms. Merkel in particular, and his alleged offer of a trade deal to French President Emmanuel Macron – if France leaves the EU – are all designed to break up the organisation so that he can deal from a position of strength with small states. As Britain's difficulties in exiting the union indicates, supply chains are so integrated across the continent that breaking up the EU would have disastrous consequences for production for all its member states and may even risk a global economic downturn.

In short, what Mr. Trump is seeking to do is to reverse the gains Europe has achieved over the last 70 years and make it beholden once again to the U.S.

—

Ravi Arvind Datt is a professor of sociology at the State University of New York at Binghamton, U.S.

Trump-Putin Meet

India must get US exemptions for Russia dealings

The meeting between US President Donald Trump and Russian President Vladimir Putin in Helsinki has provided much fodder for American political opposition. Trump is being criticised for not confronting Putin over alleged Russian interference in the 2016 US presidential election. Trump is caught between a rock and a hard place here. He is unlikely to acknowledge Russian interference as that would be tantamount to questioning the legitimacy of his own election – not something one expects Trump to do.

US-Russia relations stand at a complicated juncture today. While Trump thinks he can get along with Putin, US Congress has a very different perception of Moscow. This contradiction shows up in the promulgation of US Congress's Countering America's Adversaries Through Sanctions Act (CAATSA), which targets Russia and was signed into law by Trump last year despite his reservations. There's also a clear divide between Trump and the American intelligence community over Russia. But New Delhi would benefit from an improvement in US-Russia ties as it maintains useful and strategic relations with both. Russia is an old ally and important defence partner, while New Delhi today is looking for greater military and economic cooperation with Washington. Thus New Delhi and Trump are on the same side on this one.

This is where CAATSA becomes an impediment. For example, India is in talks to acquire Russian S-400 missile defence systems. The purchase would attract CAATSA sanctions unless exemptions are granted by the US. Indian diplomacy needs to step up to the plate and ensure the latter. Thus, Trump's outreach to Putin must be seen as an opportunity to establish clear lines of understanding on this issue between New Delhi and Washington. South Block needs to be nimble and must not be caught napping by storms roiling the strategic firmament.



THE TIMES OF INDIA

THE HINDU
INDIA'S NATIONAL NEWSPAPER SINCE 1878

18th July, 2018

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2 Rocky summit: when Trump met Putin

Donald Trump did enough, and more, to mess up his meeting with Vladimir Putin

A summit between the leaders of the world's strongest nuclear powers, which fought the Cold War for decades, is an opportunity to discuss areas of shared interest, find ways to dial down mutual tensions and work together to address global issues. But well before Donald Trump and Vladimir Putin sat down for their first formal summit meeting, in Helsinki, there were concerns that it would be overshadowed by allegations of Russian interference in the 2016 U.S. presidential election. The uproar in Washington over Mr. Trump's remarks on the Russian meddling scandal — with even accusations of treason — and his subsequent U-turn suggest that such concerns were valid. Mr. Trump could have certainly managed the summit better by addressing genuine concerns in the U.S. over allegations of Russia's election meddling. Days earlier, the U.S. Justice Department indicted 12 Russian intelligence officials for hacking and leaking emails of top Democrats. It therefore seemed surreal when the President accepted the Russian version over that of his own intelligence agencies and the Justice Department. Away from the controversy, the closed-door meeting between the leaders can be evaluated only on the progress made on a number of contentious issues before both.

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2 Rocky summit: when Trump met Putin

The new Strategic Arms Reduction Treaty (START) is set to expire in 2021 and Russia has shown interest in extending it. For a consensus, high-level talks between the U.S. and Russia are needed. From the crisis in Ukraine to the civil war in Syria, Russia-U.S. cooperation is vital to finding lasting solutions. The Iran nuclear deal, for which Mr. Putin and Barack Obama worked together despite differences, is in a shambles. Most of these issues, including the threat posed by nuclear weapons and intercontinental ballistic missiles, were discussed at the summit. But it's not clear whether the talks will lead to any significant change in policies. Since the Ukraine crisis, the West has tried different methods, including sanctions and pressure tactics, to isolate Russia and change its behaviour. But those methods have proved largely unsuccessful as Russia is now a far more ambitious foreign policy power with an enhanced presence in Eastern Europe and West Asia — even if its sanctions-hit economy is struggling. Instead of continuing a policy that has failed and ratcheted up global tensions, the Western alliance should junk its Cold War mentality and engage with Russia; Russia, in turn, will have to shed its rogue attitude and be more open and stable in its dealings. The stakes are high and the bitterness of the past should not hinder U.S.-Russia relations. That should have been the message from Helsinki.

2 Decoding Trump's attack on Europe

His incendiary tour of the continent seeks to reverse the gains Europe has achieved over the last 70 years. U.S. President Donald Trump's incendiary tour of Europe has justly generated extensive coverage for his disregard for diplomatic niceties and attacks on his allies, especially on German Chancellor Angela Merkel and British Prime Minister Theresa May, both of whom are facing stiff domestic opposition. Yet, mainstream commentaries on Mr. Trump's attacks on the European Union and the North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO) do not place the trans-Atlantic relationship in the broader historical context.

In the first instance, in the aftermath of the Second World War, the U.S. promoted economic integration among its European allies as an essential condition for the post-war revival of world trade. At war's end, wealth had become concentrated in the new superpower — it accounted for 48% of world industrial capacity and 70% of gold reserves. With the demobilisation of some 10 million soldiers in the U.S., the shift to a peacetime economy needed allies to open their markets to U.S. products and investments. Its European allies were too poor to provide a market and the notorious 'meat-axe' 80th Congress unwilling to undertake a programme for European reconstruction.

In this context, the U.K. government's admission in February 1947 that it could no longer intervene in the Greek Civil War provided an opportune moment for U.S. President Harry Truman to follow Senator Arthur Vandenberg's advice to "scare the hell out of the American people" by manufacturing the Cold War. A Congress that was not willing to aid Clement Attlee's "socialist welfare state" was eager to rebuild Western Europe and Japan as levees to defend the 'free world' against 'godless communism'.

...Contd.



2 Decoding Trump's attack on Europe

Along with NATO founded in 1949 was the Marshall Plan instituted in 1948. It was innovative not because of its size — \$17 billion over four years was not substantially more than the \$9 billion the U.S. had channelled to its European allies in the previous two years — but because it pressured West European states to reduce tariffs between themselves and to standardise regulations to facilitate the creation of a market viable enough to reap the economies of scale and for U.S. corporations to invest in the continent. This trans-Atlantic U.S. corporate expansion was welcomed by European governments and trade unions as these were the only entities with the funds to create employment.

Post-war reconstruction

A trans-Atlantic military alliance and European economic integration were thus the twin projects of a successful post-war reconstruction. Economic integration proceeded rapidly over the last 40 odd years, with the European Union (EU) becoming the largest economy on the planet and thereby threatening the U.S.

At the same time, the rationale for the NATO military alliance — to protect Western Europe from Soviet expansion and to tie Germany to its neighbours — has largely evaporated with the breakup of the USSR and the dissolution of the Warsaw Pact.

The Russian angle

In the context of the current outcry among NATO member states about the Russian annexation of Crimea from the Ukraine, it is important to recall that U.S. President George H.W. Bush and other leaders had assured Russia in 1991 that the trans-Atlantic alliance would not extend beyond East Germany's borders. Then when Russia was immensely weakened in the 1990s, U.S. President Bill Clinton led the charge to invite states in Central and Eastern Europe into the alliance.

...Contd.



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It was this expansion that led to a new confrontation with Russia once it had stabilised itself under President Vladimir Putin.

Nevertheless, there is clearly no Russian threat to Europe. Even in the case of the Ukraine, as Steven Cohen, emeritus professor of Russian studies at New York University, has argued, the crisis was precipitated in 2014 when the EU pressured the Ukrainian government to sign an agreement that would have disadvantaged Russia. When then Ukrainian President Viktor Yanukovich hesitated, he was overthrown by EU- and U.S.-supported demonstrators even though he had signed an agreement brokered by three EU foreign ministers the previous day to form a coalition government. It was this march of NATO to the frontiers of Russia that provoked Mr. Putin to intervene in the Ukraine. Recasting security

Far from Russia posing a threat to the Western alliance, the major source of destabilisation to the EU comes from the flow of migrants from Africa. In this context, it is not higher military spending by member states that is crucial but the provision of aid. Members of the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development had pledged to contribute 0.7% of their GDP as aid to the poorest countries. Germany and the U.K. spend 0.66% and 0.7%, respectively, of their GDP in aid while the U.S. spends a mere 0.18%; Mr. Trump is threatening to slash even that by a third. Spending on aid, especially to African countries, will help stem the tide of refugees coming to Europe far more effectively than policing the Mediterranean.

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2 Decoding Trump's attack on Europe

In this context, Mr. Trump's blistering attack on European states for not meeting their military spending obligations is misplaced. Not only does he fail to recognise that their military spending has risen since 2014 when they agreed to raise their military spending to 2% of their GDP by 2024 but also that European states are not positioned to be global powers. Unlike the U.S. which is bordered by the Atlantic and Pacific Oceans, Europe has no need for navies to patrol distant oceans and match the U.S. in defence spending. Moreover, rather than spending massively on defence as the U.S. has opted to do, European states provide their citizens with health care, education, and other welfare benefits. Mr. Trump's support for Brexit and his humiliating undermining of Ms. May, his outrageous comments on Germany being beholden to Russia and on Ms. Merkel in particular, and his alleged offer of a trade deal to French President Emmanuel Macron if France leaves the EU are all designed to break up the organisation so that he can deal from a position of strength with small states. As Britain's difficulties in exiting the union indicates, supply chains are so integrated across the continent that breaking up the EU would have disastrous consequences for production for all its member states and may even risk a global economic downturn.

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2 Trump-Putin meet: India must get US exemptions for Russia dealings

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US-Russia relations stand at a complicated juncture today. While Trump thinks he can get along with Putin, US Congress has a very different perception of Moscow. This contradiction shows up in the promulgation of US Congress's Countering America's Adversaries Through Sanctions Act (CAATSA), which targets Russia and was signed into law by Trump last year despite his reservations. There's also a clear divide between Trump and the American intelligence community over Russia. But New Delhi would benefit from an improvement in US-Russia ties as it maintains useful and strategic relations with both. Russia is an old ally and important defence partner, while New Delhi today is looking for greater military and economic cooperation with Washington. Thus New Delhi and Trump are on the same side on this one.

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UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II ... International Relations

Effect of policies and politics of developed and developing countries on India's interests, Indian Diaspora.

IMPORTANT QUESTION

ESSAY/ MAINS / GD / INTERVIEWS

“Economic and military integration with Europe was the natural choice for USA after the Second World War”. Critically evaluate the statement, in view of the recent trade barriers by USA and questioning of NATO.



LOOK AT THE SCENARIO AFTER THE SECOND WORLD WAR!



- 1 US promoted economic integration among its European allies. It was an essential situation for the post-war revival of world trade.
- 2 At that time, US accounted for 48% of world industrial capacity and 70% of gold reserves.
- 3 US at that time needed allies to open their markets to US products and investments.
- 4 Because of the Second World War devastation, European allies were too poor to provide a market.

MARSHALL PLAN & NATO



- 1 Marshall plan was instituted in 1948 provided more than \$15 billion to help finance rebuilding efforts on the continent.
- 2 It also pressurised west European states to reduce tariffs between themselves and to standardise regulations, to facilitate the creation of market, which will be viable enough to reap the economies of scale and facilitate US corporations to invest in the continent.
- 3 The Trans-Atlantic US Corporate Expansion was welcomed by European Govts. and trade unions. They felt that it was required to create employment.

POST-WAR RECONSTRUCTION OF EUROPE & DOMINATION OF USA



- 1 European economic integration and trans-Atlantic military alliance are the twin projects for successful post-war reconstruction.
- 2 European Union became the largest economy on the planet.
- 3 NATO military alliance protected Western Europe from Soviet Union expansion.
- 4 Now, the threats have largely evaporated with the breakup of USSR and the dissolution of the Warsaw Pact.

WHAT HAPPENED SUBSEQUENT TO 1991?



1 After the breakage of USSR, the then US President George H. W. Bush assured Russia that the trans-Atlantic Alliance would not extend beyond East Germany's borders.

2 When the Russia further weakened in 1990s, US President Bill Clinton led the charge to invite the States in Central and Eastern Europe into the Alliance.

3 It was this expansion that led to a new confrontation with Russia, once it had stabilized itself under President Vladimir Putin.

4 Even the intervention of EU-U.S. in Ukraine to sign an agreement that would have disadvantaged Russia, precipitated the crisis of Ukraine, which ultimately led to annexation of Crimea by Russia.

UKRAINE

MOLDOVA

SEA OF AZOV

Crimea

CHORNE SEA

RUSSIA

Black Sea

ROMANIA

BULGARIA



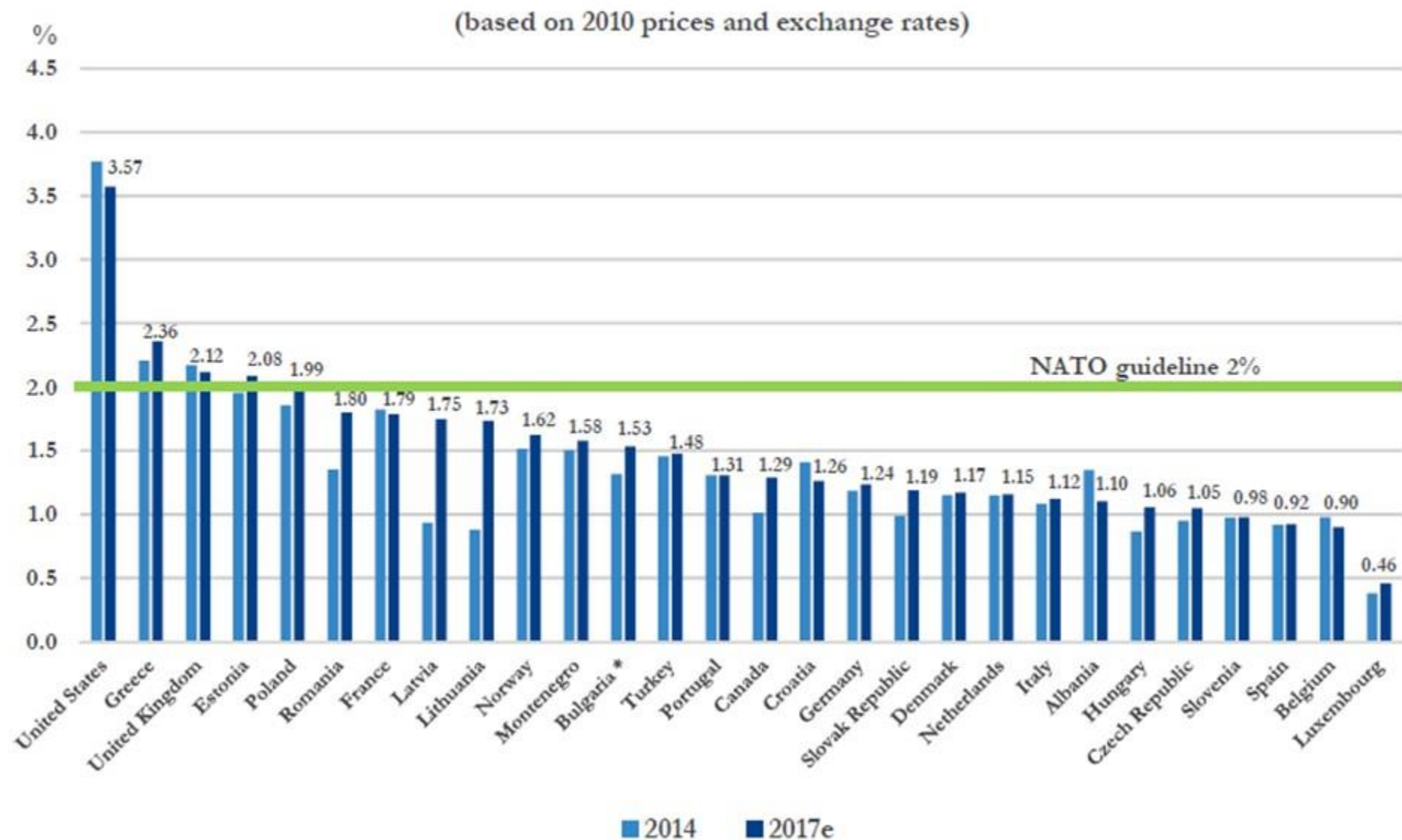
IT IS NOT RUSSIA ... MIGRANTS IS THE REAL PROBLEM



- 1 The major destabilisation comes from flow of migrants.
- 2 The higher military spending is not crucial, but the provision of aid.
- 3 Members of the OECD had pledged to contribute 0.7% of their GDP, as aid to the poorest countries.
- 4 Germany and the U.K. spent 0.66% and 0.7% respectively, of their GDP as aid, while the U.S. spends a mere 0.18%.

Spending on aid, especially to African countries, will help stem the tide of refugees coming to Europe far more effectively than policing the Mediterranean.

DEFENCE EXPENDITURE AS A SHARE OF GDP (%)



WHAT IS THE FINAL CONCLUSION?



- 1 European Union countries are not positioned to be global powers, Europe has no need to send navies for patrol in the distant oceans.
- 2 Rather than spending massively on defence, European states provide their citizens with healthcare, education and other welfare benefits.
- 3 Now, the actions of US President are inline to breakup the organisation, so that he can deal with a position of strength with smaller states.

What Mr. Trump seeks to do is to reverse the gains Europe had achieved over the last 70 years.

WHAT ABOUT TRUMP-PUTIN SUMMIT?



1 Trump is criticised for not confronting Putin over alleged Russian interference in 2016 US Presidential Election.

2 He is in a catch-22 situation. Acknowledging Russian interference would tantamount to questioning the legitimacy of his own election.

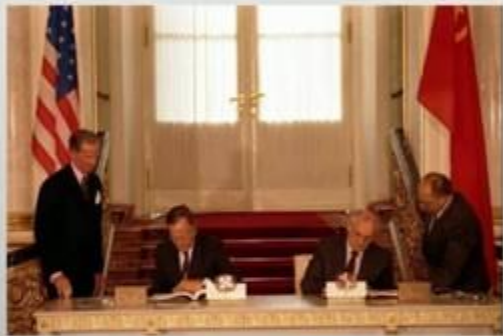
3 CAATSA targets Russia and was signed into law last year.

4 Few days ago, the U.S. Justice Department indicted 12 Russian intelligence officials for hacking and leaking emails of top Democrats.

5 Now, the President accepted Russian version over that of his own intelligence agencies and the Justice Department.

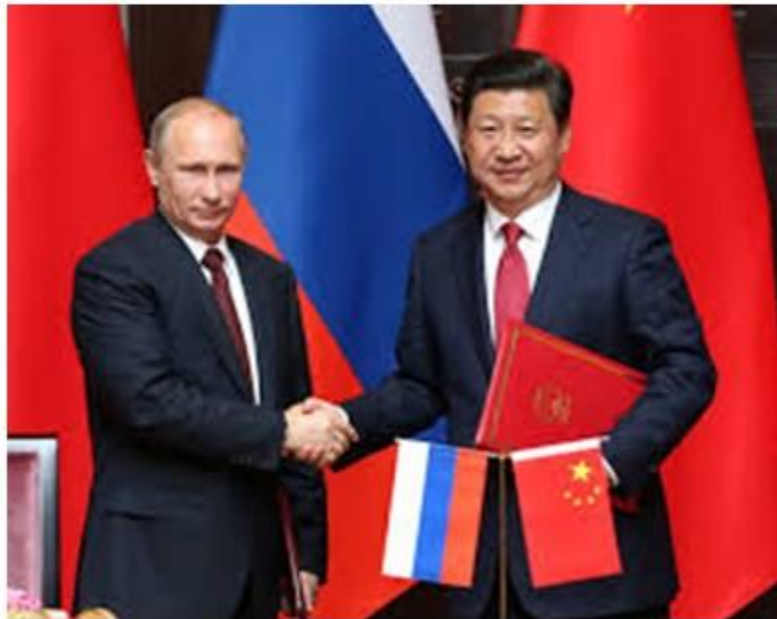
WHAT ARE THE IMPORTANT ASPECTS BETWEEN USA & RUSSIA?

Strategic Arms Reduction Treaty



- 1 New Strategic Arms Reduction Treaty (START) is set to expire in 2021, Russia has shown interest in extending it and high-level talks are required between both the countries.
- 2 From the crisis in Ukraine to the civil war in Syria, Russia-U.S. cooperation is vital for finding the lasting solutions.
- 3 Iran nuclear deal is in shambles.

PRESENT DAY RUSSIA IS HIGHLY EMBOLDENED!



- Russia is now a far more ambitious foreign policy power.
- It has enhanced its presence in Eastern Europe.
- It is coming closer to China.
- It's engagement in West Asia is increasing.



The Western Alliance should junk its Cold War mentality and engage with Russia, whereas Russia has to shed its rogue attitude and should be more open and stable in its dealings.

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